SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #58 · FEAR AND THE NEWS

"Terrible things are about to happen to me."

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Where it often comes from

After loss, a bad diagnosis, trauma, or a pattern of anxious thinking, the mind keeps scanning for the next blow. Sleep and concentration suffer, and the future feels like a threat.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, "Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own." "Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you." "Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus." "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you." We cannot control the future, but we can trust the One who holds it.

> *"Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own"* (Matthew 6:34).

Also see

> "Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness" (Isaiah 41:10).

> "Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus" (Philippians 4:6–7).

> "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you" (1 Peter 5:7).

> "When I am afraid, I put my trust in You. In God, whose word I praise— in God I trust. I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?" (Psalm 56:3–4).

Common self-statements

- Something awful is coming.
- I can feel it.
- I always get bad news.
- I cannot relax.
- I am waiting for the other shoe to drop.
- I will not be able to handle it.

Common logical errors

- Catastrophizing: Expecting the worst.
- Fortune telling: Predicting disaster without evidence.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling dread and concluding that danger is coming.
- Mental filter: Focusing on threats and ignoring what is going well.

Challenging questions

- What specifically do I fear?
- How often have my worst predictions come true?
- What has God brought me through before?
- What is happening now that is okay?
- What does Scripture say about worry?
- What can I do today about this fear?

Truth summary

> I cannot predict the future, and most feared things never happen. God is with me and will help me with what comes, one day at a time. I can bring my fears to Him and receive His peace.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anxiety/Worry
- Fear
- Peace
- Trust
- Thinking, Unhealthy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Terrible things are about to happen to me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Terrible things are about to happen to me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I fear?
- ☐ How often has it come true?
- ☐ What has God brought me through?
- ☐ What is okay now?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ What can I do today?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Today has enough trouble of its own.
- ☐ God is with me.
- ☐ He will strengthen and help me.
- ☐ His peace will guard my heart.
- ☐ He cares for me.
- ☐ I can face today.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Matthew 6:34**
  "Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own."
- ☐ **Isaiah 41:10**
  "Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness."
- ☐ **Philippians 4:6–7**
  "Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] One day at a time: Each week, note one fear that did not come true.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Matthew 6:34 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will not worry about tomorrow. God is with me today.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Anxiety/Worry" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Write the fear. Describe it and how likely it is.
- [ ] Track predictions. Keep a log of fears and outcomes.
- [ ] Pray Philippians 4:6–7. Present each worry to God.
- [ ] Return to today. Do one useful thing now.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Terrible things are about to happen to me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One day at a time
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Terrible things are about to happen to me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, my mind runs ahead to disasters. Thank You that You are with me today. Give me Your peace, and help me trust You with tomorrow. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.